Learn the Signs. Act Early.

Milestones by 5 Years

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For Everyone

MAY 15, 2026 • ESPAÑOL

WHAT TO KNOW

- Learn about the developmental milestones that most babies do by 5 years of age.
- See important information to share with your doctor.
- Find tips and activities you can do for your 5-year-old.



Ways to monitor milestones

How your child plays, learns, speaks, acts, and moves offers important clues about your child's development. Developmental miles things most children (75% or more) can do by a certain age.

Milestone checklists

Check the milestones your child has reached by 5 years by completing a checklist, available below and in three additional formats:

- CDC's free *Milestone Tracker* mobile app, for iOS and Android devices
- Web-based Digital Online Checklist
- Printable checklist PDF

Keep in mind

Learn the Signs. Act Early. materials are not a substitute for standardized, validated developmental screening tools.

What most children do by 5 years

Click the links below to view a photo or video of each milestone.

Social/Emotional Milestones

- Follows rules or takes turns when playing games with other children
- Sings, dances, or acts for you
- Does simple chores at home, like matching socks or clearing the table after eating

Language/Communication Milestones

- Tells a story she heard or made up with at least two events. For example, a cat was stuck in a tree and a firefighter saved it
- Answers simple questions about a book or story after you read or tell it to him
- Keeps a conversation going with more than three back-and-forth exchanges
- Uses or recognizes simple rhymes (bat-cat, ball-tall)

Cognitive Milestones (learning, thinking, problem-solving)

- Counts to 10
- Names some numbers between 1 and 5 when you point to them
- Uses words about time, like “yesterday,” “tomorrow,” “morning,” or “night”
- Pays attention for 5 to 10 minutes during activities. For example, during story time or making arts and crafts (screen time does r
- Writes some letters in her name
- Names some letters when you point to them

Movement/Physical Development Milestones

- Buttons some buttons
- Hops on one foot

SEE ALSO
More about physical development

Share with your child’s doctor

Things to share and consider

- What are some things you and your child do together?
- What are some things your child likes to do?
- Is there anything your child does or does not do that concerns you?
- Has your child lost any skills he/she once had?
- Does your child have any special healthcare needs or was he/she born prematurely?

You know your child best. Don't wait. If your child is not meeting one or more milestones, has lost skills he or she once had, or you concerns, act early. Talk with your child's doctor, share your concerns, and ask about developmental screening.

If you or the doctor are still concerned

- Ask for a referral to a specialist who can evaluate your child more; and
- Call your state or territory's early intervention program to find out if your child can get services to help. Learn more and find t at cdc.gov/FindEI.

KEEP READING

Concerned About Your Child's Development?

Tips and activities

What You Can Do for Your 5-year-old



As your child's first teacher, you can help his or her development.

As your child's first teacher, you can help his or her learning and brain development. Try these simple tips and activities in a safe w your child's doctor and teachers if you have questions or for more ideas on how to help your child's development.

- Your child might start to "talk back" in order to feel independent and test what happens. Limit the attention you give to the nega Find alternative activities for her to do that allow her to take the lead and be independent. Make a point of noticing good behavic calm when I told you it's bedtime."
- Ask your child what she is playing. Help her expand her answers by asking "Why?" and "How?" For example, say "That's a nice l building. Why did you put it there?"
- Play with toys that encourage your child to put things together, such as puzzles and building blocks.

More Parenting Tips and Activities

- Use words to help your child begin to understand time. For example, sing songs about the days of the week and let him kno it is. Use words about time, such as today, tomorrow, and yesterday.
- Let your child do things for himself, even if he doesn't do it perfectly. For example, let him make his bed, button his shirt, or p into a cup. Celebrate when he does it and try not to "fix" anything you don't have to.
- Talk about and label your child's and your own feelings. Read books and talk about the feelings characters have and why the them.
- Play rhyming games. For example, say "What rhymes with cat?"
- Teach your child to follow rules in games. For example, play simple board games, card games, or Simon Says.
- Create a spot in your home for your child to go to when he's upset. Stay nearby so your child knows he is safe and can come help calming as needed.
- Set limits for screen time (TV, tablets, phones, etc.) for your child, to no more than 1 hour per day. Make a media use plan for family.
- Eat meals with your child and enjoy family time talking together. Give the same meal to everyone. Avoid screen time (TV, tab phones, etc.) during mealtime. Let your child help prepare the healthy foods and enjoy them together.
- Encourage your child to "read" by looking at the pictures and telling the story.
- Play games that help with memory and attention. For example, play card games, Tic Tac Toe, I Spy, or Hot and Cold.
- Let your child play with other children, such as at a park or library. Ask about local play groups and pre-school programs. Pla others helps your child learn the value of sharing and friendship.
- Teach your children about safe touch, such as hugging when both people want to and touches that help keep children health from doctors or parents). Unsafe touches are touches that might make a child feel hurt, uncomfortable, scared, or confused. T children that they are in charge of who touches them. Help them practice saying 'no' to unwanted or unsafe touch and let the there are adults they can turn to for help.
- Teach your child to look for "helpers" if she is lost or needs help, such as parents with children, a store clerk with a badge, or officer. Teach your child her name and your name (first and last names).
- Encourage your child to pretend play. Help your child find items she can use to play dress up, school, or house.
- Keep a box of crayons, paper, paint, child scissors, and glue for creative play. Encourage your child to draw and make art proj different supplies.
- Take your child to the playground. Teach her how to pump her legs back and forth on a swing and help her play on the monk
- Create a calm, quiet bedtime routine. Avoid any screen time (TV, tablets, phones, etc.) for 1 to 2 hours before bed and don't p screens in your child's bedroom. Children this age need 10 to 13 hours of sleep a day (including naps). Consistent sleep time easier!
- Read to your child. Ask questions, such as "What is happening in the picture?" and "What do you think will happen next?"
- Explore things your child likes. For example, if he loves animals, get some library books about animals, look for birds and squ park, or visit a zoo to learn about animals.
- Try to make time for active play each day. Your child will have more fun if she can choose the activity. For example, give her c such as playing music and dancing together, playing outside, or taking a walk together.
- Your child might start to talk back or use profanity (swear words) as a way to feel independent. Do not give a lot of attention other than a brief time out. Instead, praise your child when he asks for things nicely and calmly takes "no" for an answer.

- Help your child be ready for new places and meeting new people. For example, you can read stories or role play (pretend pla her get ready for Kindergarten.

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National Center on Birth Defects and Developmental Disabilities (NCBDDD)

ABOUT THIS PAGE

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